



Colorado State Committee Meeting – March 24, 2026

Regular Session Minutes

Meeting Place:	Colorado State Office Denver Federal Center Lakewood, CO 80225 and Via TEAMS
Members Present:	Don Brown, Chairperson Darrell Mackey, Member Kyle McConnell, Member Steve Raftopoulos,, Member Joe Petrocco, Member (Via Teams)
Staff Present:	Jerry Sonnenberg, State Executive Director Jon Weishaar, Deputy State Executive Director Cindy Vukasin, Farm Program Chief Corey Pelton, Farm Program Chief Janae Rader, Farm Program Specialist Doug Andresen, Farm Program Specialist Julie Sporhase, Farm Program Specialist Hunter Cleveland, Farm Program Specialist Woody Woods, District Director Scott Brase, District Director Sam Montoya, District Director
Guests:	None

1. Call to Order

The Colorado State Committee (STC) met on March 24, 2026, in person at the Colorado State office in Denver, Don Brown, State Committee Chairperson opened the Regular Session at 9:10 a.m.

2. Monthly Leadership Reports (Exhibit 1)

A State Executive Director Report

Jerry Sonnenberg, State Executive Director, gave STO staff a written report of items, events, and pertinent information since the last STC meeting.

B District Director Reports

District Directors, Scott Brase (District 1), Jon Weishaar (Acting for District 2), Woody Woods (District 3) and Sam Montoya (District 4) gave the STC written reports regarding their specific districts and included information pertaining to programs, staffing updates, weather conditions, and other pertinent information since the last STC meeting.

C Acting Farm Loan Chief Report

Kim Lacy, Acting Farm Loan Program Chief, provided the STC with a written report of items, events, and pertinent information regarding farm loan and staff since the last STC meeting.

D Farm Program Chief Reports

Cindy Vukasin, Farm Program Chief provided an oral report and Corey Pelton, Farm Program Chief, gave the STC a written report of items, events, and pertinent information regarding farm programs and staff since the last STC meeting.

E Deputy State Executive Director Report

Jon Weishaar, Deputy State Executive Director, gave the STC an oral report of items, events, and pertinent information since the last STC meeting. A written report will be provided for the minutes.

3. Otero COC Action

A Delegation of Authority from COC to CED

Jon Weishaar, Deputy State Executive Director, presented to the STC information in Exhibit 2 for the STC to review act on pertaining to delegating Otero/Crowley COC authority to Dara Belew, CED for Otero and Crowley Counties.

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 1), Steve Raftopoulos, moved to delegate Otero/Crowley COC authorities listed in exhibit 1 to Dara Belew, CED for Otero and Crowley Counties. Darrell Mackey seconded the motion. Motion passed.

4. County Committee Elections

A Review of 2025 COC Election Reports

Jon Weishaar, Deputy State Executive Director, presented the STC with the information in Exhibit 3 for to approve or disapprove the Colorado 2025 County Committee Election results for all Colorado counties.

The 2025 COC election timeline was modified following the government shutdown. The final date for COCs to count ballots for 2025 COC elections was February 17, 2026. In accordance with 15-AO (Rev. 5), paragraph 157, offices are required to send election summaries along with a memorandum recommending approval or disapproval to the State

Committee. The State Committee will review the election reports and either approve the election or disapprove the election.

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 3), Kyle McConnell made a motion to approve the Colorado 2025 COC Election results, as presented. Steve Raftopoulos, seconded the motion. Motion passed.

B STC to Appoint 2026 SDA Advisors

Jon Weishaar, Deputy State Executive Director, presented to the STC all County Committee's recommendations for their Socially Disadvantaged Advisor (Exhibit 4) for review and determine if their recommendation should be approved.

The 2025 COC election timeline was modified following the government shutdown. The 2026 COC SDA advisor timeline was modified to accommodate the updated election timeline. The final date for COCs to submit names of all eligible nominees and supporting information with a recommendation for selection to the State Committee (STC) was March 16, 2026. STC will confirm and appoint advisors before April 15, 2026.

According to 16-AO Par. 145, COC's are required to have Socially Disadvantaged (SDA) representation on the County Committees. If representation is not given through an elected, voting member position, COCs are required to solicit candidates from the primary SDA group within their county and recommend an SDA Advisor. SDA Advisors are non-voting members but allow the SDA groups to ensure that they are being represented. After outsourcing and finding a qualified SDA to serve as an advisor, the COC is required to submit their recommendation to the STC for approval.

After reviewing the 2025 COC election results it was determined that the following COCs have an absence of an elected or appointed SDA COC member.

- Bent
- Boulder
- Kiowa
- Logan
- Phillips
- Prowers
- Sedgwick

The Cheyenne COC has an elected SDA member who is Hispanic/Latino. During the organizational meeting, the Cheyenne COC discussed the need for a female SDA advisor for COC due to the number of female producers in Cheyenne County who are running larger operations. The COC members determined that they should recommend an SDA advisor to represent the female producers in the County.

All other COCs have an elected or appointed SDA member, do not require an appointed SDA advisor, and have not requested an SDA advisor.

SDA advisors recommended by the applicable county that are absence of an elected or appointed SDA COC member and are requesting an additional female SDA advisor are listed below.

2026 Colorado COC Advisor Recommendation Summary

County	District	COC Recommended Advisor
Bent	1	Etta Jean Sykes
Boulder	2	Lisa Jimenez
Cheyenne	1	Judy Jacobs
Kiowa	1	Melissa Jones
Logan	3	Donelle Harms
Phillips	3	Kelsey Garretson
Prowers	1	Suzan Denyce Widener-Block
Sedgwick	3	Tammy Schneider

The STC reviewed documentation and recommendations submitted by the counties along with policy (Exhibit 4). Kyle McConnell moved to approve the all counties SDA recommendations as presented. Steve Raftopoulos, seconded the motion. Motion passed.

5. Noninsured Crop Disaster Assistance Program (NAP)

A 2025 Independent Assessment Grazing Losses

Janae Rader, Farm Program Specialist, presented to the STC with information in Exhibit 5 for STC to review and concur or non-concur with the 2025 grazing loss percentages as required by notice NAP-235 and CO NAP-69 and notification of COC approved actions under NAP-235 and CO NAP-69.

Losses submitted by counties are listed in table below for 2025 non-irrigated grass and improved grass and 2025 irrigated grass and improved grass for producers using Independent Assessments.

County	COC Recommended % Loss	
Gunnison	70.00	Ir
Montrose	70.00	Ir
Ouray	70.00	Ir
Bent	12.50	Ni
Crowley	15.00	Ni
Gunnison	60.00	Ni
Montrose	60.00	Ni
Otero	25.00	Ni
Ouray	60.00	Ni

The STC reviewed the COC's recommendations and ensured their recommendation is aligned with policy and reasonable for the applicable county.

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 5). Kyle McConnell moved to accept and approve the COC recommended Losses as listed above and presented for 2025 non-irrigated grass and improved grass. Steve Raftopoulos, seconded the motion. Motion passed.

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 5). Kyle McConnell moved to accept and approve the COC recommended Losses as listed above and presented for 2025 irrigated grass and improved grass. Steve Raftopoulos, seconded the motion. Motion passed.

B NCT Dates and Factors Data – Per STC Request

Janae Rader, Farm Program Specialist provided STC with an searchable excel spreadsheet that included Dates and Factors for the NCT as requested by the STC during the February meeting. This document was uploaded to Box for easy access.

6. STC Policy and Delegation Review

The STC is to review STC policies and delegations of authority set and granted the previous year. STC to act on these policies and delegations accordingly for them to be effective during the 2026 calendar year.

A AGRICULTURE FOREIGN INVESTMENT DISCLOSURE (AFIDA)

Julie Sporhase, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with STC policies and delegations of authority in Exhibit 6A for STC to review and act on.

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6A), Steve Raftopoulos, moved to approve STC policies and delegations of authority as presented. Kyle McConnell seconded the motion. Motion passed.

B EMERGENCY RELIEF PROGRAM (ERP)

Julie Sporhase, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with STC policies and delegations of authority in Exhibit 6B for STC to review and act on.

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6B), Kyle McConnell moved to approve STC policies and delegations of authority as presented. Darrell Mackey seconded the motion. Motion passed.

C FARM STORAGE FACILITY LOAN (FSFL)

Julie Sporhase, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with STC policies and delegations of authority in Exhibit 6C for STC to review and act on.

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6C), Kyle McConnell moved to approve STC policies and delegations of authority as presented. Joe Petrocco seconded the motion. Motion passed.

D COMMODITY LOANS (8-LP)

Julie Sporhase, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with STC policies and delegations of authority in Exhibit 6D for STC to review and act on.

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6D), Kyle McConnell moved to approve STC policies and delegations of authority as presented. Steve Raftopoulos, seconded the motion. Motion passed.

E PAYMENT LIMITATION (PL) 5-PL

Julie Sporhase, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with STC policies and delegations of authority in Exhibit 6E for STC to review and act on.

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6E), Kyle McConnell moved to approve STC policies and delegations of authority as presented. Darrell Mackey seconded the motion. Motion passed.

F PAYMENT LIMITATION (PL) 6-PL

Julie Sporhase, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with STC policies and delegations of authority in Exhibit 6F for STC to review and act on.

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6F), Kyle McConnell moved to approve STC policies and delegations of authority as presented. Darrell Mackey seconded the motion. Motion passed.

G MARKETING ASSISTANCE SPECIALTY CROPS (MASC)

Julie Sporhase, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with STC policies and delegations of authority in Exhibit 6G for STC to review and act on.

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6G), Kyle McConnell moved to approve STC policies and delegations of authority as presented. Steve Raftopoulos, seconded the motion. Motion passed.

H SUPPLEMENTAL DISASTER RELIEF PROGRAM (SDRP)

Julie Sporhase, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with STC policies and delegations of authority in Exhibit 6H for STC to review and act on.

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6H), Kyle McConnell moved to approve STC policies and delegations of authority as presented. Darrell Mackey seconded the motion. Motion passed.

I COMMON MANAGEMENT (CM) 1-CM

Doug Andresen, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with STC policies and delegations of authority in Exhibit 6I for STC to review and act on.

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6I), Kyle McConnell moved to approve STC policies and delegations of authority as presented. Steve Raftopoulos, seconded the motion. Motion passed.

J COMMON MANAGEMENT (CM) 10-CM

Doug Andresen, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with STC policies and delegations of authority in Exhibit 6J for STC to review and act on.

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6J), Kyle McConnell moved to approve STC policies and delegations of authority as presented. Steve Raftopoulos, seconded the motion. Motion passed.

K COMMON PROVISIONS (COMPLIANCE) 2-CP

Doug Andresen, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with STC policies and delegations of authority in Exhibit 6K for STC to review and act on.

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6K), Kyle McConnell moved to approve STC policies and delegations of authority as presented. Darrell Mackey seconded the motion. Motion passed.

L ORGANIC CERTIFICATION COST SHARE PROGRAM (OCCSP) 1-OCCSP

Doug Andresen, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with STC policies and delegations of authority in Exhibit 6L for STC to review and act on.

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6L), Kyle McConnell moved to approve STC policies and delegations of authority as presented. Steve Raftopoulos, seconded the motion. Motion passed.

M NONINSURED CROP DISASTER ASSISTANCE PROGRAM

Janae Rader, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with STC policies and delegations of authority in Exhibit 6M for STC to review and act on.

1) SUBPAR. 12E, 12F - DD Review for CCC-770s

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6M), Kyle McConnell moved to approve STC policies and delegations of authority as presented. Darrell Mackey seconded the motion. Motion passed.

2) SUBPAR. 53 A - Established Ineligible Crops

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6M), Kyle McConnell moved to approve STC policies and delegations of authority as presented. Steve Raftopoulos, seconded the motion. Motion passed.

3) SUBPAR. 277 F - Carrying Capacity and Grazing Periods

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6M), Kyle McConnell moved to approve STC policies and delegations of authority as presented. Steve Raftopoulos, seconded the motion. Motion passed.

4) PAR 300 - RMA / FSA Closing Date review

No action required.

5) SUBPAR. 502 V - Reduction of Yield

a) Sweet Cherries, Dwarf

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6M), Kyle McConnell moved to approve STC policies and delegations of authority as presented. Darrell Mackey seconded the motion. Motion passed.

b) Hops

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6M), Kyle McConnell moved to approve STC policies and delegations of authority as presented. Darrell Mackey seconded the motion. Motion passed.

6) SUBPAR. 504 B - Converting Grain, Silage, & Dry Forage

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6M), Kyle McConnell moved to approve STC policies and delegations of authority as presented. Steve Raftopoulos, seconded the motion. Motion passed.

7) SUBPAR. 804 I - Establishing Grazing Loss

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6M), Kyle McConnell moved to approve STC policies and delegations of authority as presented. Darrell Mackey seconded the motion. Motion passed.

8) SUBPAR. 804 J - Submitting Independent Assessments for Grazed Acreage Conditions

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6M), Kyle McConnell moved to approve STC policies and delegations of authority as presented. Darrell Mackey seconded the motion. Motion passed.

9) SUBPAR. 804 K - Establishing an Area

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6M), Kyle McConnell moved to approve STC policies and delegations of authority as presented. Steve Raftopoulos, seconded the motion. Motion passed.

10) PAR. 809 - Establish Laboratories for Quality Loss

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6M), Kyle McConnell moved to approve STC policies and delegations of authority as presented. Darrell Mackey seconded the motion. Motion passed.

N LIVESTOCK FORAGE PROGRAM (LFP)

Janae Rader, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with STC policies and delegations of authority in Exhibit 6N for STC to review and act on.

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6N), Kyle McConnell moved to approve STC policies and delegations of authority as presented. Steve Raftopoulos, seconded the motion. Motion passed.

O TREE ASSISTANCE PROGRAM

Janae Rader, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with STC policies and delegations of authority in Exhibit 6O for STC to review and act on.

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6O), Kyle McConnell moved to approve STC policies and delegations of authority as presented. Darrell Mackey seconded the motion. Motion passed.

P WILDFIRES AND HURRICANES INDEMNITY PROGRAM+ (WHIP+)

Janae Rader, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with STC policies and delegations of authority in Exhibit 6P for STC to review and act on.

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6P), Kyle McConnell moved to approve STC policies and delegations of authority as presented. Steve Raftopoulos, seconded the motion. Motion passed.

Q EMERGENCY CONSERVATION PROGRAM (ECP)

Hunter Cleveland, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with STC policies and delegations of authority in Exhibit 6Q for STC to review and act on.

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6Q), Kyle McConnell moved to approve STC policies and delegations of authority as presented. Darrell Mackey seconded the motion. Motion passed.

R EMERGENCY FOREST RESTORATION PROGRAM (EFRP)

Hunter Cleveland, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with STC policies and delegations of authority in Exhibit 6R for STC to review and act on.

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6R), Kyle McConnell moved to approve STC policies and delegations of authority as presented. Darrell Mackey seconded the motion. Motion passed.

S EMERGENCY LIVESTOCK ASSISTANCE PROGRAM (ELAP)

Hunter Cleveland, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with STC policies and delegations of authority in Exhibit 6S for STC to review and act on.

1) SUBPAR. 8G - Eligible Weather Event Oversight Policy

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6S), Kyle McConnell moved to approve STC policies and delegations of authority as presented. Steve Raftopoulos, seconded the motion. Motion passed.

2) SUBPAR. 72A - Maximum Snow Removal Rate

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6S), Kyle McConnell moved to strike the proposed rate of \$206 and approve the previous rate of \$276 that is within the STC policies and authority. Darrell Mackey seconded the motion. Motion passed.

T LIVESTOCK INDEMNITY PROGRAM (LIP)

Hunter Cleveland, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with STC policies and delegations of authority in Exhibit 6T for STC to review and act on.

1) SUBPAR. 4A – Normal Mortality Rates

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6T), Kyle McConnell moved to approve STC policies and delegations of authority as presented. Darrell Mackey seconded the motion. Motion passed.

2) SUBPAR. 4B - Extreme Heat and Extreme Cold

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6T), Steve Raftopoulos, moved to table LIP STC policies for Extreme Heat and Extreme Cold until the next meeting when the requested additional information is presented. Darrell Mackey seconded the motion. Motion passed.

3) SUBPAR. 22B - Eligible Weather Event Oversight Policy

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6T), Kyle McConnell moved to approve STC policies and delegations of authority as presented. Steve Raftopoulos, seconded the motion. Motion passed.

U Colorado Policy and Handbooks

Darrell Mackey moved that State Specialists are to update the applicable Handbooks with State policy and delegations approved by the STC. Steve Raftopoulos, seconded the motion. Motion passed.

7. State Committee Field Discussion update

Steve Raftopoulos,, STC member, inquired about Wyoming's carrying capacity and grazing days used for LFP and ELAP compared to Colorados. Janae Rader, Farm Program Specialist, provided detailed background on the previous STC decision. She will follow up and provide the STC will additional information at the next scheduled STC meeting.

STC inquired about staffing and what happens when we do not have enough staff. SED Sonnenberg replied that this concern is at the forefront of our conversations. Concerns about burnout and increased mistakes are discussed often amongst management.

Don Brown, inquired about general Farm Loan eligibility, applying and servicing actions.

8. Adjournment

There being no further business, the Regular Session was adjourned at 2:36 p.m. The next meeting is scheduled for April 23, 2026 via TEAMS.

Approved:

State Committee Chairperson

Date

State Executive Director

Date

Colorado State Committee Meeting

Regular Session 03.24.2026

Exhibits

	Page
Exhibit 1: Leadership Reports.....	14
Exhibit 2: AO-Otero: Otero 2026 COC Delegations to CED.....	24
Exhibit 3: COC: 2025 COC Election Reports.....	31
Exhibit 4: COC: 2026 COC SDA Advisors STC Appointment.....	137
Exhibit 5: NAP: 2025 Independent Assessment Grazing Losses.....	156
Exhibit 6: AO: 2026 Delegations and Review of STC policy.....	371
Exhibit 6A 2026 Delegations and STC Policy AFIDA.....	372
Exhibit 6B 2026 Delegations and STC Policy ERP.....	374
Exhibit 6C 2026 Delegations and STC Policy FSFL.....	377
Exhibit 6D 2026 Delegations and STC Policy 8 LP.....	385
Exhibit 6E 2026 Delegations and STC Policy PL – 5 PL.....	389
Exhibit 6F 2026 Delegations and STC Policy PL – 6 PL.....	393
Exhibit 6G 2026 Delegations and STC Policy MASC.....	398
Exhibit 6H 2026 Delegations and STC Policy SDRP.....	400
Exhibit 6I 2026 Delegations and STC Policy CM – 1 CM.....	402
Exhibit 6J 2026 Delegations and STC Policy CM – 10 CM.....	405
Exhibit 6K 2026 Delegations and STC Policy CP – 2 CP.....	407
Exhibit 6L 2026 Delegations and STC Policy OCCSP.....	416

Exhibit 6: AO: 2026 Delegations and Review of STC policy Continued

Exhibit 6M 2026 Delegations and STC Policy NAP – 1 NAP.....419

Exhibit 6N 2026 Delegations and STC Policy LFP.....590

Exhibit 6O 2026 Delegations and STC Policy TAP.....594

Exhibit 6P 2026 Delegations and STC Policy WHIP+.....598

Exhibit 6Q 2026 Delegations and STC Policy ECP.....615

Exhibit 6R 2026 Delegations and STC Policy EFRP.....617

Exhibit 6S 2026 Delegations and STC Policy ELAP.....619

Exhibit 6T 2026 Delegations and STC Policy LIP.....632